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1 INDIGENISING 5G COMMUNICATION WITH OPTIMUS RHINO 5G

Defence startup OptimusLogic Systems, based in Bengaluru, is making waves across all bands of the 5G spectrum with their indigenously designed 5G mobile phone



The team at OptimusLogic Systems with their founder Chandra Kumar Chettiar (centre)

Throgs of people and the telecom behemoths bore witness on October 1, 2022, as India was ushered into a new era of technological advancements with the inauguration of the 5G band, at the 6th Edition of India Mobile Congress 2022, at Pragati Maidan, New Delhi. On this momentous occasion, a small but enterprising group of individuals unveiled India's first indigenously manufactured 5G smartphone—Optimus Rhino 5G.

Founded in 2013 by Chandra Kumar Chettiar as a startup that built devices and subsystems for

defence PSUs such as BEL and DRDO, OptimusLogic Systems Pvt Ltd began their journey with an initial investment of ₹20 million. As a Digital Communication Innovation Square (DCIS) scheme grantee, and with the support of the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), the company has been able to manufacture a 5G smartphone that can support all the 5G bands in a very small form factor.

The phone is currently available in three different models—Optimus Rhino 5G 1, Optimus Rhino 5G 2, and Optimus Rhino 5G 4 (rugged

MIL-810G/IP68).

Out of the total smartphone base of about 600 million in India, only 50-60 million handsets are estimated to be 5G smartphones, even as the first 5G smartphone was unveiled in 2020. The Optimus Rhino 5G is an indigenous product of the Voice of Indian Communication Technology Enterprises (VoICE) consortium, which asked multiple technology and R&D players to set up a 5G based mobile communication network in the 82km Palwal-Mathura sector of the Indian Railways on 700MHz band.

“Most of the phones manufactured by a consumer brand support the N78 (3500MHz) frequency band. If you take multiple use cases for the army and the railways, they have been allotted the 5MHz spectrum in the 700MHz band, because the lower the frequency, the higher the range. Optimus Rhino 5G supports all these bands and global network bands of major countries,” explains Chettiar.

The Optimus Rhino 5G 1 comes with a large storage capacity of 8GB RAM, 128GB flash drive, and a quad camera setup at a modest price of ₹20,000. Consumers also have the option of getting a discount of ₹2,000 if they choose to assemble the phone on their own and order the assembly kit.

It has an octa-core MediaTek Di-